

Components of Writing a Penetration Test Report

CompTIA PenTest+ (PT0-003)

Domain: 1.0: Engagement Management

Objectives:

- 1.4: Explain the components of a penetration test report
- 1.5: Given a scenario, analyze the findings and recommend the appropriate remediation within a report.

Video Overview

This video explains the essential components of a penetration test report, providing context on why a well-structured report is vital for effective communication with clients. As you watch, consider how the principles of clear communication and audience-tailored content apply not only to cybersecurity but also to other professional fields and how these reporting skills are directly applicable to your future career as a penetration tester.

Key Topics Covered

- **Report Audience:** Technical and non-technical stakeholders (e.g., C-suite, IT staff)
- **Executive Summary:** High-level overview of findings and recommendations for non-technical readers
- **Scope Details:** Defining tested systems, networks, and applications
- **Methodology and Attack Narrative:** Documenting the testing approach, tools, and exploitation steps with screenshots and notes
- **Findings Section:** Including risk ratings (e.g., NIST SP 800-30), risk prioritization, and business impact analysis
- **Remediation Steps:** Specific recommendations for addressing identified vulnerabilities
- **Report Lifecycle:** Storage duration, retesting, and compliance considerations
- **Secure Distribution:** Methods for securely transferring sensitive reports

Student Notes Section (Optional)